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Guidance (grey): delete before sending. Print on your institution's letterhead, keep it to one page, and address the editor by name. The letter sells the paper: why it matters and why it fits THIS journal.

[DD Month YYYY]

Dr *[Editor's full name]*
[Editor-in-Chief], *[Journal name]*
[Journal postal or online address]

Dear Dr *[Editor's surname]*,

Re: Submission of the manuscript "*[Full title]*"

Please consider our manuscript for publication as an *[Original Research article]* in *[Journal name]*.

Paragraph 2: the question and why it matters (2–3 sentences).

[e.g. Fluid accumulation is common in septic shock, but whether restricting fluids improves survival is unknown.]

Paragraph 3: what you did and the main finding, with the key number, calibrated to the design.

[e.g. In this pilot randomised trial of 60 adults, a restrictive strategy was feasible, and 28-day mortality was ... (risk ratio ..., 95% CI ...).]

Paragraph 4: why this journal: its scope, readers, or recent papers on the topic.

[e.g. The findings are directly relevant to your readers in critical care and extend your recent work on fluid stewardship.]

We confirm that this manuscript is original, has not been published and is not under consideration elsewhere *[a preprint is available at ...]*. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission. The study was approved by *[Ethics committee name]* (no. *[number]*) and registered at *[registry, number]*. It is reported according to *[CONSORT / STROBE / ...]*; the completed checklist is attached. The authors declare *[no competing interests]*.

Optional: suggested reviewers (name, institution, email, expertise; no collaborators from the last 3 years) and reviewers to exclude, with a reason.

Thank you for considering our work. We look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,

[Name, qualifications]
[Corresponding author, on behalf of all authors]
[Department, Institution · email · phone · ORCID]